

SAHANSA JAYAWARDHANA

THE LANGUAGE OF STAYING



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One Hundred Reflections on the Nature of Love

by

Sahansa Jayawardhana

Love is not what it is called.

It is what it does.

*To my beloved soulmate,
my chutibatichiiiiii.*

About the Author

SAHANSA JAYAWARDHANA is just a normal person with a heart full of love, because of the people who are the same as him in his life.

I

Sharing a bad every night is not love.

Talking around the clock is not love.

Laying around doing nothing is not love.

∞

LOVE IS someone seeing you at your absolute lowest and holding you just as tight. It is someone who steps up when you have nothing left to give, quietly taking on the weight until you can stand again on your own feet.

II

Posting every detail of your relationship is not love.

Curating a perfect feed for others to see is not love.

Showing off a romance for validation is not love.

∞

LOVE HAPPENS in the quiet moments no camera ever catches. It is the silent understanding across a crowded room, the shared joke nobody else gets, and the relief of coming home to someone who knows every version of you.

III

Buying expensive jewelry is not love.

Surprising someone with grand romantic trips is not love.

Throwing money at a problem to make it disappear is not love.

∞

LOVE IS remembering how someone takes their coffee on a freezing morning. It is picking up their favorite snack on a random Tuesday because you knew they had a rough week at work.

IV

Never having an argument is not love.

Agreeing on every single detail is not love.

Bending every personal value to avoid conflict is not love.

∞

LOVE IS knowing how to disagree without trying to destroy each other. It is having the maturity to listen, apologize sincerely, and rebuild stronger after the dust settles.

V

Constantly checking someone's location is not love.

Demanding passwords to every account is not love.

Monitoring who someone talks to is not love.

∞

LOVE GIVES you room to breathe. It is the deep confidence that comes from trusting someone completely, knowing they choose you every single day, even when you are not in the same room.

VI

Texting every minute of the day is not love.

Expecting instant replies to every message is not love.

Panicking over a few hours of silence is not love.

∞

LOVE UNDERSTANDS that life gets busy. It is the peace of knowing that a gap in conversation does not mean a gap in affection.

VII

Moving in together after two weeks is not love.

Rushing into big decisions just to feel secure is not love.

Trying to speed through life milestones is not love.

∞

LOVE RESPECTS time. It lets a bond grow naturally, rooted in deep conversations and shared experiences, building a foundation sturdy enough to last a lifetime.

VIII

Changing everything about yourself for someone is not love.

Dressing the way they want you to dress is not love.

Abandoning your hobbies to fit their lifestyle is not love.

∞

LOVE ENCOURAGES you to become more of who you truly are. It admires your unique quirks, supports your personal passions, and never asks you to shrink to fit into their world.

IX

Publicly declaring your devotion is not love.

Making big speeches in front of crowds is not love.

Writing long paragraphs on social media is not love.

∞

LOVE PROVES itself when no one is watching. It is the steady, everyday effort of being reliable, honest, and kind when there is no audience around to applaud.

X

Assuming you know what your partner thinks is not love.

Expecting someone to read your mind is not love.

Leaving problems unspoken until they explode is not love.

∞

LOVE IS open, honest communication. It is sitting down to talk through difficult feelings with patience, empathy, and a genuine desire to fix the problem together.

XI

Giving gifts to make up for bad behavior is not love.

Saying sorry without changing the habit is not love.

Expecting immediate forgiveness after hurting someone is not love.

∞

LOVE SHOWS real remorse through changed actions over time. It respects the healing process and works hard every day to earn back broken trust.

XII

Isolating yourself from friends and family is not love.

Making your partner your entire world is not love.

Cutting off old relationships to prove loyalty is not love.

∞

LOVE EXPANDS your life instead of shrinking it. It respects your existing relationships, values your community, and encourages you to keep strong connections outside of the partnership.

XIII

Expecting your partner to fix your mood is not love.

Relying on someone else for your complete happiness is not love.

Making your emotional stability someone else's burden is not love.

∞

LOVE IS taking responsibility for your own emotional health while offering a safe landing spot for theirs. It is two complete people choosing to walk side by side.

XIV

Obsessively checking up on their past is not love.

Comparing yourself to their exes is not love.

Holding previous relationships against them is not love.

∞

LOVE MEETS people where they are today. It honors the journey that shaped them while focusing entirely on building a shared present and future.

XV

Staying together strictly out of habit is not love.

Fearing being alone more than being miserable is not love.

Settling because you have already invested time is not love.

∞

LOVE IS an active choice made every morning. It is looking at someone and deciding that you would choose them all over again, knowing all their flaws and baggage.

XVI

Fixing someone who does not want to change is not love.

Treating a partner like a project to complete is not love.

Loving who someone could be instead of who they are is not love.

∞

LOVE ACCEPTS the person standing in front of you right now. It supports their growth without trying to force them into a mold you created in your mind.

XVII

Trying to outdo each other with favors is not love.

Keeping a mental scorecard of who did what is not love.

Bringing up past favors during an argument is not love.

∞

LOVE GIVES freely without expecting a transaction in return. It finds joy in making the other person's life easier, simply because you care about their well-being.

XVIII

Dating someone purely for their potential is not love.

Waiting for someone to change their core values is not love.

Hoping someone will magically turn into a different person is not love.

∞

LOVE LOVES the present reality. It builds on mutual respect for who both of you are right now, not who you hope to mold each other into years down the road.

XIX

Sharing every secret instantly is not love.

Forcing someone to open up before they are ready is not love.

Demanding access to every corner of someone's mind is not love.

∞

LOVE HONORS personal boundaries and timing. It creates a safe, nonjudgmental space where someone feels comfortable opening up at their own pace.

XX

Always agreeing to keep the peace is not love.

Swallowing your feelings to avoid an argument is not love.

Pretending everything is fine when it is not is not love.

∞

LOVE WELCOMES tough conversations. It gives you the courage to speak your truth, knowing that the relationship is strong enough to handle honest feedback.

XXI

Splitting every single bill strictly in half is not love.

Treating finances like a business contract is not love.

Using money as a way to control the other person is not love.

∞

LOVE APPROACHES life as a team. It looks at resources as a shared tool to build a comfortable, stable life where both people feel supported and secure.

XXII

Bragging about how much you sacrifice for them is not love.

Making your partner feel guilty for your choices is not love.

Using your effort as leverage in arguments is not love.

∞

LOVE GIVES quietly and willingly. It makes sacrifices out of genuine care, without holding them over the other person's head like a debt to be repaid.

XXIII

Expecting constant excitement and butterflies is not love.

Chasing the thrill of the honeymoon phase forever is not love.

Panicking when things feel calm and routine is not love.

∞

LOVE FINDS beauty in stability and quiet comfort. It understands that peace and predictability are often the ultimate signs of a healthy, lasting connection.

XXIV

Complimenting only someone's appearance is not love.

Focusing entirely on how your partner looks is not love.

Valuing surface traits over character is not love.

∞

LOVE SEES the depth of who you are. It admires your kindness, your resilience, your mind, and your spirit long after physical appearances inevitably change over time.

XXV

Trying to control who your partner hangs out with is not love.

Telling someone what they can and cannot wear is not love.

Making rules for an adult partner is not love.

∞

LOVE RESPECTS individual freedom. It rests on mutual trust, allowing both people to make their own choices without fear of unjust judgment or control.

XXVI

Using silent treatment as a punishment is not love.

Withholding affection to get your way is not love.

Shutting down completely during conflict is not love.

∞

LOVE STAYS present even when things get uncomfortable. It communicates openly, works through misunderstandings, and stays committed to resolving the issue together.

XXVII

Matching each other's bad moods is not love.

Escalating an argument just to win is not love.

Feeding off each other's stress and anger is not love.

∞

LOVE BRINGS calm to the storm. It recognizes when a partner is overwhelmed and offers a steady, grounding force to help bring balance back to the room.

XXVIII

Planning every detail of the future alone is not love.

Making major life choices without asking is not love.

Expecting someone to just follow your path is not love.

∞

LOVE CREATES a vision together. It sits down, listens to both sets of goals and dreams, and works to map out a shared path forward where both feel valued.

XXIX

Ignoring red flags because you feel lonely is not love.

Making excuses for harmful behavior is not love.

Hoping someone will treat you better next time is not love.

∞

LOVE DEMANDS respect and safety from the start. It recognizes your worth and refuses to accept treatment that tears down your spirit or peace of mind.

XXX

Expecting perfection from your partner is not love.

Holding someone to impossible standards is not love.

Criticizing every small mistake they make is not love.

∞

LOVE LEAVES plenty of room for mistakes and human flaws. It offers grace, patience, and gentle humor when things do not go as smoothly as planned.

XXXI

Buying expensive gifts after an argument is not love.

Using material items to quiet an upset partner is not love.

Trying to buy someone's forgiveness is not love.

∞

LOVE ADDRESSES the heart of the issue directly. It offers genuine accountability, honest listening, and actual effort toward long-term emotional resolution.

XXXII

Overanalyzing every text message is not love.

Reading into tone and punctuation for hidden meanings is not love.

Creating drama out of simple misunderstandings is not love.

∞

LOVE GIVES the benefit of the doubt. It approaches interactions with trust, assuming good intentions instead of looking for reasons to feel insecure.

XXXIII

Using your partner's secrets against them in a fight is not love.

Bringing up past mistakes to hurt them is not love.

Weaponizing vulnerability to win an argument is not love.

∞

LOVE PROTECTS vulnerable truths. It holds personal confidences with sacred care, refusing to use them as weapons even during the heated moments of a disagreement.

XXXIV

Matching your partner's toxic energy is not love.

Playing mind games to test their loyalty is not love.

Trying to make someone jealous to see if they care is not love.

∞

LOVE VALUES emotional security and clarity. It communicates directly and honestly, avoiding manipulative tactics that breed anxiety and self-doubt.

XXXV

Assuming your partner will never change is not love.

Holding someone hostage to who they used to be is not love.

Refusing to acknowledge personal growth is not love.

∞

LOVE CELEBRATES evolution. It gives people space to mature, learn from past mistakes, and transform into better versions of themselves over time.

XXXVI

Expecting someone to always put your needs before theirs is not love.

Taking advantage of a generous partner is not love.

Ignoring their boundaries for your own comfort is not love.

∞

LOVE SEEKS balance and mutual support. It ensures that both people feel heard, nourished, and cared for, without one person carrying all the emotional weight.

XXXVII

Staying together just for social status is not love.

Using a partner to fit a certain image is not love.

Keeping someone around to look successful to others is not love.

∞

LOVE IS an authentic connection that stands on its own merits. It thrives on genuine emotional depth, regardless of how it looks to the outside world.

XXXVIII

Telling someone what they feel is wrong is not love.

Invalidating an emotional reaction because you disagree is not love.

Dismissing a partner's pain as dramatic is not love.

∞

LOVE VALIDATES emotions even when it does not fully understand them. It offers empathy, a listening ear, and a willingness to see life through their eyes.

XXXIX

Making promises you have no intention of keeping is not love.

Using future plans as a way to stall in the present is not love.

Giving false hope just to keep someone close is not love.

∞

LOVE MATCHES words with clear, steady action. It honors commitments and respects the other person's time, trust, and long-term expectations.

XL

Laughing at your partner's insecurities is not love.

Making fun of their passions in front of others is not love.

Teasing someone until they feel small is not love.

∞

LOVE PROTECTS self-worth. It builds a partner up, honors their unique interests, and makes sure they always feel safe and valued in your presence.

XLI

Assuming the worst when a mistake happens is not love.

Jumping to harsh conclusions without facts is not love.

Refusing to listen to an explanation is not love.

∞

LOVE LEADS with grace and understanding. It approaches problems with curiosity rather than immediate judgment, working to find the truth together.

XLII

Expecting someone to be your main source of entertainment is not love.

Relying on a partner to cure your boredom is not love.

Demanding all of their free time for yourself is not love.

∞

LOVE RESPECTS independent lives. It encourages both partners to cultivate their own hobbies, friendships, and personal interests outside the relationship.

XLIII

Relying on physical attraction to solve real issues is not love.

Using intimacy to avoid addressing deep problems is not love.

Sweeping emotional distance under the rug is not love.

∞

LOVE DOES the hard emotional work. It builds a deep intellectual and emotional foundation that holds strong even when physical energy changes over time.

XLIV

Expecting your partner to handle all domestic chores is not love.

Treating shared life tasks as optional favors is not love.

Leaving all the mental burden of home life to one person is not love.

∞

LOVE SHARES the load fairly. It steps up to take care of daily responsibilities, recognizing that real partnership means looking out for each other's energy.

XLV

Comparing your partner to someone else is not love.

Pointing out what other people do better is not love.

Making someone feel inadequate compared to peers is not love.

∞

LOVE APPRECIATES the unique individual in front of them. It focuses on their specific strengths and values the distinct dynamic you share together.

XLVI

Feeling competitive with your partner is not love.

Resenting their personal success or achievements is not love.

Trying to outshine them in public or private is not love.

∞

LOVE TREATS success as a shared victory. It genuinely cheers for your partner's accomplishments, celebrating their wins as if they were your own.

XLVII

Ignoring a partner's need for quiet time is not love.

Taking personal space as a threat or insult is not love.

Forcing interaction when someone is exhausted is not love.

∞

LOVE RESPECTS personal recharge time. It understands that taking time alone to regroup is often necessary to show up well for the relationship later.

XLVIII

Staying in a relationship out of obligation is not love.

Staying out of fear of hurt feelings is not love.

Dragging out an unhealthy dynamic to avoid awkwardness is not love.

∞

LOVE VALUES truth and long-term peace. It is honest about feelings, making hard choices with respect and clarity rather than living a continuous lie.

XLIX

Expecting your partner to share all your exact views is not love.

Dismissing their opinions when they differ from yours is not love.

Trying to debate them out of their values is not love.

∞

LOVE VALUES independent thinking. It appreciates the perspective an individual brings, recognizing that differences can enrich the bond rather than break it.

L

Focusing only on the big milestones is not love.

Waiting for special events to show appreciation is not love.

Ignoring the quiet daily moments that build trust is not love.

∞

LOVE LIVES in the ordinary days. It shines in the quick morning hugs, the shared glances across a table, and the steady presence through unremarkable Tuesdays.

LI

Dismissing a partner's stress as unimportant is not love.

Telling someone to just get over something heavy is not love.

Comparing your daily stress to minimize theirs is not love.

∞

LOVE MEETS people in their emotional reality. It offers a calm listening space, validating their stress without needing to turn it into a competition.

LII

Expecting someone to always remain the same is not love.

Resenting every natural change in personality or goals is not love.

Holding a partner to who they were years ago is not love.

∞

LOVE GROWS alongside the person. It embraces the evolving chapters of life, continuously falling in love with the new versions of each other along the way.

LIII

Using guilt to get what you want is not love.

Making your partner feel bad for having social plans is not love.

Manipulating emotions to control decisions is not love.

∞

LOVE RESPECTS individual agency. It supports choices made out of genuine desire, never resorting to guilt or pressure to force a desired outcome.

LIV

Demanding complete transparency while keeping secrets yourself is not love.

Holding your partner to rules you do not follow is not love.

Operating under a double standard is not love.

∞

LOVE RESTS on simple equality. It holds both people to the same standards of honesty, respect, and mutual effort every single day.

LV

Expecting a partner to fix your past emotional scars is not love.

Blaming them for pain caused by someone else is not love.

Making them pay for lessons learned in previous relationships is not love.

∞

LOVE DOES the internal work. It takes ownership of personal healing, allowing the new relationship to start fresh without carrying old baggage into it.

LVI

Hiding your true feelings to keep things smooth is not love.

Wearing a mask to avoid disappointing someone is not love.

Pretending to be fine when you are hurt is not love.

∞

LOVE THRIVES on honest vulnerability. It builds an environment where both people can show their raw, messy emotions without fear of rejection.

LVII

Trying to win every debate is not love.

Prioritizing being right over protecting the bond is not love.

Refusing to back down when feelings are hurt is not love.

∞

LOVE VALUES relationship peace over personal ego. It focuses on finding solutions together rather than keeping score of who won the argument.

LVIII

Expecting your partner to anticipate your every need is not love.

Getting upset over unexpressed expectations is not love.

Testing someone's devotion through unspoken demands is not love.

∞

LOVE SPEAKS clearly and directly. It expresses needs with honesty and clarity, giving the other person a fair opportunity to step up and support you.

LIX

Taking care of someone only when it is convenient is not love.

Disappearing when life gets complicated or messy is not love.

Offering support only when energy allows is not love.

∞

LOVE SHOWS up through every season. It remains steady during illness, financial stress, loss, and the heavy storms that test a commitment over time.

LX

Checking off boxes on a relationship checklist is not love.

Following a timeline because of social pressure is not love.

Doing things just because it is what comes next is not love.

∞

LOVE BUILDS a unique life path. It moves at a pace that feels right for the two people involved, ignoring outside timelines and social expectations.

LXI

Using affection as a bargaining chip is not love.

Being kind only when you want something in return is not love.

Treating warmth like currency is not love.

∞

LOVE OFFERS steady warmth and care. It flows naturally from a place of genuine affection, without conditions or hidden expectations attached.

LXII

Assuming you know what is best for your partner is not love.

Making decisions on their behalf without asking is not love.

Overriding their choices under the guise of caring is not love.

∞

LOVE HONORS personal autonomy. It trusts the other person's judgment, offering advice only when asked, and fully supporting their ultimate decisions.

LXIII

Ignoring personal boundaries when you feel like it is not love.

Pushing someone past their comfortable limit is not love.

Treating personal boundaries as roadblocks to clear is not love.

∞

LOVE TREATS boundaries with care. It respects personal space and limits, recognizing that healthy boundaries strengthen trust rather than weaken it.

LXIV

Expecting your partner to share all of your interests is not love.

Forcing someone to participate in every single hobby is not love.

Resenting a partner for having different passions is not love.

∞

LOVE GIVES space for individuality. It appreciates that separate interests give each person room to grow, bringing fresh energy back into the home.

LXV

Giving up on a partner during a personal rough patch is not love.

Walking away when things get emotionally difficult is not love.

Demanding constant positivity is not love.

∞

LOVE PROVIDES a steady anchor. It stays close through dark seasons, offering patient support while the other person works through their challenges.

LXVI

Expecting absolute perfection from a relationship is not love.

Panicking over every normal rough patch is not love.

Thinking every conflict means the end is not love.

∞

LOVE UNDERSTANDS that real life is messy. It embraces the ups and downs as natural parts of growth, staying committed to working through obstacles together.

LXVII

Using sarcasm to attack someone's character is not love.

Disguising mean comments as simple jokes is not love.

Undermining a partner's confidence in front of friends is not love.

∞

LOVE PROTECTS emotional safety. It uses words to encourage, validate, and build up, never taking cheap shots at a partner's expense.

LXVIII

Expecting a partner to fill every role in your life is not love.

Looking for one person to be your entire world is not love.

Placing the weight of all your needs on one set of shoulders is not love.

∞

LOVE ENCOURAGES a full, balanced life. It values a supportive network of friends, family, and community alongside a strong primary relationship.

LXIX

Assuming a relationship takes care of itself is not love.

Stopping all active effort once secure is not love.

Taking a partner's presence for granted is not love.

∞

LOVE REQUIRES steady daily care. It invests time, attention, and intentional effort into keeping the bond alive and growing through every stage of life.

LXX

Loving someone only for how they make you feel is not love.

Focusing entirely on what you receive from the dynamic is not love.

Treating a partner like a mirror for your own life is not love.

∞

LOVE SEES and values the other person as an individual. It cares deeply about their happiness, dreams, and well-being, independent of what they offer you.

LXXI

Fixating on past mistakes after forgiveness was granted is not love.

Bringing up old errors during new disagreements is not love.

Holding long-term grudges within a home is not love.

∞

LOVE OFFERS true forgiveness. Once a mistake is addressed and healed, it leaves it in the past, allowing the relationship to move forward unburdened.

LXXII

Expecting a partner to change their core personality is not love.

Wishing an introvert would suddenly become an extrovert is not love.

Trying to change basic nature is not love.

∞

LOVE APPRECIATES the natural design of a person. It finds comfort in who they are, building a lifestyle that honors both partners' temperaments.

LXXIII

Showing affection only in public settings is not love.

Being attentive when others are watching but distant at home is not love.

Treating a relationship like a public performance is not love.

∞

LOVE SHINES brightest in private. It gives its best care, kindness, and focused attention behind closed doors when no one else is around.

LXXIV

Expecting a partner to fix all your problems is not love.

Handing over responsibility for your life choices is not love.

Blaming them when things go wrong in your world is not love.

∞

LOVE TAKES full personal responsibility. It works through individual challenges while leaning on a partner for mutual encouragement and emotional support.

LXXV

Ignoring a partner's boundaries around physical touch is not love.

Pressuring someone into intimacy is not love.

Treating physical affection like an obligation is not love.

∞

LOVE PRIORITIZES safety, comfort, and mutual consent. It respects a partner's body and timing, making sure touch is always grounded in care and respect.

LXXVI

Expecting your partner to manage your stress for you is not love.

Bringing home unmanaged anger and dumping it out is not love.

Making your bad day everyone else's problem is not love.

∞

LOVE PRACTICES self-awareness. It learns to handle individual stress responsibly, protecting the peaceful home environment built together.

LXXVII

Dismissing a partner's goals as unrealistic is not love.

Pouring cold water on their long-term dreams is not love.

Discouraging someone from taking healthy risks is not love.

∞

LOVE SERVES as a reliable launchpad. It believes in a partner's potential, offering steady support as they reach for challenging personal goals.

LXXVIII

Keeping secrets to protect your own comfort is not love.

Lying by omission to avoid hard conversations is not love.

Hiding facts to control a partner's reaction is not love.

∞

LOVE CHOOSES honesty over personal comfort. It trusts the relationship with the truth, knowing that genuine trust requires total transparency.

LXXIX

Expecting a partner to carry all the emotional labor is not love.

Leaving the work of maintaining the connection to one person is not love.

Assuming emotional harmony just happens is not love.

∞

LOVE IS a shared responsibility. Both people actively check in, address underlying issues, and work to nurture the emotional heart of the relationship.

LXXX

Treating a partner like an opponent during arguments is not love.

Trying to defeat them in a debate is not love.

Focusing on winning instead of understanding is not love.

∞

LOVE REMEMBERS you are on the same team. It approaches disagreements with a desire to solve the issue together, protecting the bond above personal pride.

LXXXI

Expecting your partner to be cheerful all the time is not love.

Disliking when they feel sad, quiet, or weary is not love.

Demanding a smile when life gets heavy is not love.

∞

LOVE MAKES room for the full spectrum of human emotion. It stands steadily beside someone through sadness, grief, and quiet days without demanding a front.

LXXXII

Using money or gifts to control decisions is not love.

Creating financial dependency to keep someone near is not love.

Using financial support as a leash is not love.

∞

LOVE EMPOWERS independence. It uses shared resources to build security and freedom for both people, never as a tool for control or influence.

LXXXIII

Assuming small unkind acts do not matter is not love.

Dismissing frequent small slights as no big deal is not love.

Letting daily respect slip away slowly over time is not love.

∞

LOVE GUARDS everyday politeness and respect. It understands that lasting trust is built or broken through small, daily interactions over many years.

LXXXIV

Expecting a partner to follow your personal lifestyle completely is not love.

Forcing someone into your routines and habits is not love.

Refusing to compromise on daily living patterns is not love.

∞

LOVE CREATES a blended way of living. It makes space for both people's habits, finding rhythms that respect each individual's comfort and preference.

LXXXV

Using family or friends to pressure a partner is not love.

Ganging up on someone during a disagreement is not love.

Bringing outside voices in to win a home argument is not love.

∞

LOVE PROTECTS the private nature of the dynamic. It works through problems directly between the two people involved, keeping outside pressure out of disputes.

LXXXVI

Expecting a partner to absorb all your negative energy is not love.

Using someone as an emotional dumping ground without checking in is not love.

Taking their listening ear for granted is not love.

∞

LOVE ASKS for permission before sharing heavy loads. It considers the other person's mental capacity, ensuring emotional support stays healthy and mutual.

LXXXVII

Dismissing a partner's physical pain or fatigue is not love.

Telling someone to push through when they are exhausted is not love.

Ignoring their physical limits is not love.

∞

LOVE OFFERS gentle, practical care. It encourages rest, steps up to handle responsibilities, and makes sure a partner feels cared for when energy runs low.

LXXXVIII

Expecting a relationship to stay effortless forever is not love.

Giving up the moment active effort is required is not love.

Thinking real connection requires zero work is not love.

∞

LOVE EMBRACES the quiet work of staying connected. It shows up for hard discussions, schedule adjustments, and continuous alignment through every stage of life.

LXXXIX

Comparing your current partner to ideal figures is not love.

Holding someone to fictional standards is not love.

Wishing your partner was a completely different person is not love.

∞

LOVE SEES and chooses the real person in front of them. It appreciates real character over perfection, building a life grounded in practical everyday reality.

XC

Expecting a partner to make up for all past disappointments is not love.

Looking for someone to heal every old scar is not love.

Placing the weight of your past history on a new relationship is not love.

∞

LOVE LETS a new story begin. It gives the current relationship a clean slate, allowing trust and connection to build naturally without heavy expectations.

XCI

Using silence as a weapon to force compliance is not love.

Refusing to talk for days to punish a mistake is not love.

Creating anxiety through intentional coldness is not love.

∞

LOVE STAYS open and accessible. Even when space is needed to cool down, it communicates clearly that the relationship remains secure and valued.

XCH

Expecting your partner to sacrifice their career goals completely is not love.

Treating one person's aspirations as secondary is not love.

Ignoring someone's professional goals for your own is not love.

∞

LOVE RESPECTS personal ambition. It works to find balances that honor both partners' career goals, celebrating professional progress along the way.

XCIII

Dismissing a partner's intuitive feelings is not love.

Telling someone they are crazy for noticing changes in tone is not love.

Invalidating internal instincts is not love.

∞

LOVE OFFERS reassurance and clarity. It addresses concerns with patience, helping restore peace of mind through open, honest reflection.

XCIV

Expecting a partner to handle all spiritual or emotional growth alone is not love.

Refusing to grow alongside someone is not love.

Leaving a partner to evolve by themselves is not love.

∞

LOVE LEARNS and grows together. It engages in deep conversations, reads, reflects, and works to expand awareness as a united pair.

XCV

Assuming a partner knows you love them without saying or showing it is not love.

Letting daily warmth dry up because of longevity is not love.

Treating affection as unnecessary after years together is not love.

∞

LOVE CONTINUES to speak warm appreciation out loud. It keeps simple acts of care alive, ensuring the foundation feels secure day in and day out.

XCVI

Trying to manage how a partner expresses their personality is not love.

Toning down their humor or enthusiasm in public is not love.

Feeling embarrassed by their natural joy is not love.

∞

LOVE TAKES pride in a partner's natural spark. It lets them shine brightly, enjoying the energy and life they bring into every room they enter.

XCVII

Expecting a partner to put up with disrespectful family members is not love.

Failing to defend someone against outside slights is not love.

Leaving a partner unprotected in tough social situations is not love.

∞

LOVE BUILDS a united front. It sets boundaries with outside influences, ensuring both people feel defended, supported, and prioritized.

XCVIII

Treating small everyday requests as annoying demands is not love.

Grumbling every time a partner asks for a quick favor is not love.

Making someone feel like a burden for needing assistance is not love.

∞

LOVE SERVES with a willing heart. It finds simple satisfaction in helping out, offering a helping hand with ease and steady good humor.

XCIX

Expecting a relationship to replace personal self-worth is not love.

Looking for a partner to give you validation you lack internally is not love.

Relying on someone else to make you feel valuable is not love.

∞

LOVE STARTS with personal self-respect. It brings a grounded, confident individual into a dynamic where two people enhance each other's existing sense of worth.

C

Thinking love is just a feeling that comes and goes is not love.

Leaving when the romantic excitement dips is not love.

Treating commitment as an option dependent on daily moods is not love.

∞

LOVE IS a daily practice, a chosen commitment, and a decision made over and over. It is standing firm through every trial, choosing to build, protect, and cherish the connection every single day.